DAY 34 · THEORY HANDOUT

Answer From Your Own Documents

Connect retrieval, context, a prompt, and a local chat model.

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The idea and its useful terms

Connect retrieval, context, a prompt, and a local chat model.

RAG

Retrieval-Augmented Generation.

Retrieved context

Useful text returned by document search.

Grounded answer

An answer supported by the supplied evidence.

A model may not know our private class timetable. RAG brings the relevant text into the request when the question is asked.

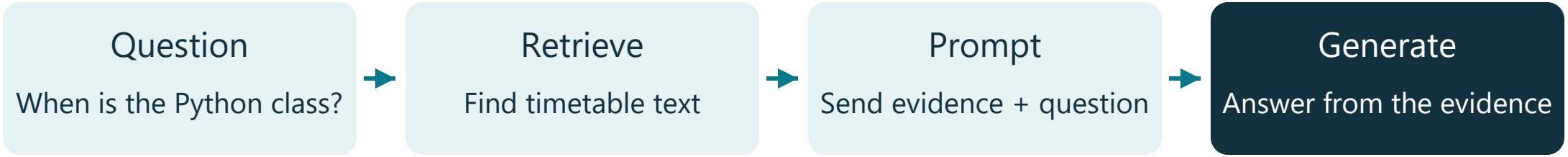
The document index is built before questions arrive. At answer time we search, format the found text, and ask the model to use it.

> RAG supplies evidence at request time. It does not fine-tune the model or guarantee that it uses the evidence correctly.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

The index is prepared from documents before a question arrives. At question time, the retriever selects text. A helper adds source labels, and the prompt sends this evidence together with the original question.

The model generates from the supplied context and its learned behavior. The prompt asks it to admit missing facts. Inspect the retrieved context first, then the answer. Source labels make this comparison practical.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Evidence

Python: Monday, 10:00.

Source: timetable.txt.

Supported question

When is Python?

The evidence has it.

Missing answer

What is the fee?

No fee is provided.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Retrieve first

Inspect which text arrived.

Wrong retrieval hurts answers.

Cite the source

Keep document labels.

Make facts easy to check.

Say unknown

When evidence is missing.

Do not fill gaps with guesses.

Build a tiny index and a RAG chain in the same notebook.

Ask one supported question and inspect both context and answer.

> Ask an unsupported fee question. Check whether the reply says it cannot find the answer.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Ask an unsupported fee question. Check whether the reply says it cannot find the answer.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

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DAY 34 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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